



few moments later, during Islamic Studies...
another paper.

Another A.

Zayd simply stared. His hands trembled.
He wasn't dreaming. He had done it.
But he started hearing mumblings of the
other students. Not complete sentences.
But just enough.

"Teacher's pet, he got the questions earlier", "The questions
on his paper is different". "Special needs version". It struck
him deeply. None of it was true. He didn't understand
why they would say that.

He ran all the way home, barely remembering to take off
his shoes before bursting through the front door.

"Ummi!"

"Abbu!"

"I got an A!"

His mother laughed with tears in her eyes.

His father smiled wider than Zayd had ever seen before.

That evening, they celebrated with Zayd's favourite meal.

There was laughter around the table.